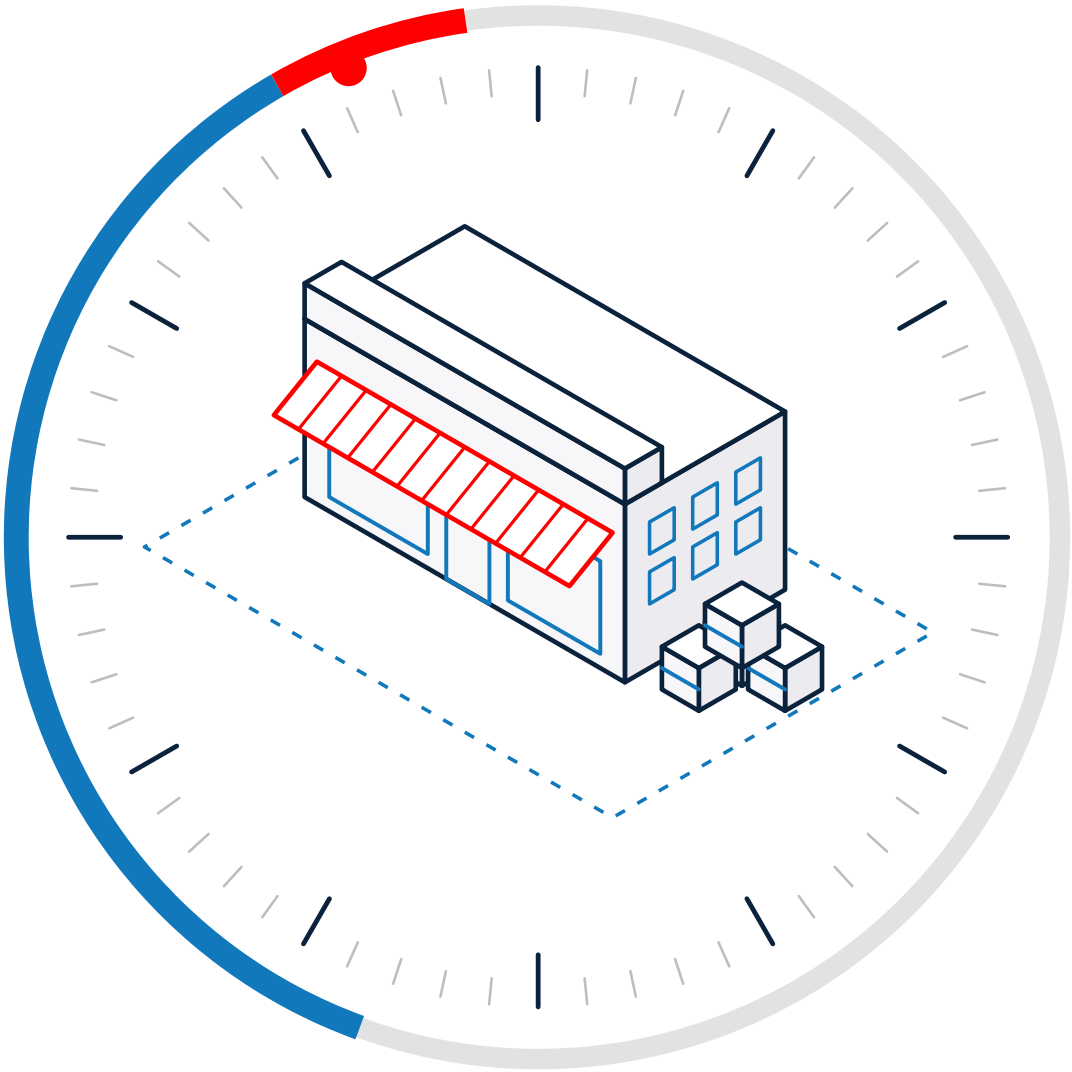


RETAIL · INTELLIGENCE REPORT

When the tills go dark.

M&S, Co-op, Ahold Delhaize, ASOS and the supermarket fridge attacks. What the evidence shows about retail disruption, colleague safety and the rules retailers face in the UK, the US, Europe and the Gulf.

INSIDE

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An evidence-based look at the incidents that have tested retailers in the UK, Europe and the US since 2025: cyber attacks that stopped online trading, a rogue message to app users, refrigeration controllers switched off from the internet and violence against shop workers, with the rules that apply in the UK, the US, the EU and the Middle East.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Retail disruption now starts in systems most shoppers never see, and ends on the shop floor.

In April 2025 a cyber attack forced Marks and Spencer to pause online orders for 46 days; it estimated the hit to operating profit at around £300m before mitigation and later booked £131.3m of incident costs against £100m of insurance proceeds.[1,2,3] The Co-op lost an estimated £206m of sales in six months and confirmed that data on all 6.5 million members had been taken.[4,5]

Autumn 2026 brought new patterns. Ahold Delhaize took systems offline in October and expects fourth-quarter sales to be €200m to €250m lower.[6] ASOS app users received an unauthorised push notification after an employee's credentials were obtained by impersonation.[7] And attackers switched supermarket refrigeration into defrost: around 700 French supermarkets were affected in October, and a second wave on 2 November reached Ireland, Belgium, Sweden and UK food suppliers.[8,9,10]

On the shop floor in the UK, the BRC estimates over 1,600 incidents of violence and abuse against retail staff a day.[11] A UK offence of assaulting a retail worker is now in the Crime and Policing Act 2026 but is not yet in force, and Martyn's Law will require larger UK shops to plan for evacuation, invacuation, lockdown and communication.[12,13]

This report sets out what happened, separates disclosed figures from claims, compares the breach notification and cold-chain rules in four regions, and ends with practical steps for retail leaders wherever they trade.

THE BOTTOM LINE

Treat payment, store systems, refrigeration controllers and colleague safety as one resilience problem, owned at board level, with a single way to alert and coordinate every store and a plan rehearsed before peak.

KEY FINDINGS

Seven things the evidence tells us

01 **Shutting systems down is often the right call, and it is expensive.**

M&S, the Co-op and Ahold Delhaize all took systems offline to contain attacks; each then faced weeks of disrupted online trading, availability or supply.[4,6,14]

02 **Stores kept trading, but not normally.**

Shops stayed open in every case, yet colleagues dealt with payment problems, empty shelves, wrong shelf prices and failed loyalty scanners.[2,4,15]

03 **People, not code, opened the door.**

M&S says attackers tricked staff at a third-party contractor; ASOS says an attacker impersonated a trusted contact to obtain an employee's credentials.[2,7]

04 **Recovery takes months, not days.**

M&S restored its online offer in August 2025 and recorded £131.3m of incident costs for the year; its fashion recovery took longer than expected.[3,14]

05 **Operational technology is now a retail attack surface.**

CERT-FR reported numerous compromised refrigeration controllers. Danfoss said most affected units were end of life and no longer patched.[8,16]

06 **Violence remains high even as it falls.**

Incidents fell to 1,617 a day from over 2,000, but remain far above the 455 a day recorded in 2019 to 2020.[11]

07 **In the UK, new legal duties are coming, but not yet live.**

The retail worker assault offence and Martyn's Law duties are both enacted but awaiting commencement.[12,13]

AT A GLANCE

Retail disruption, in six figures

Each figure is sourced. Some are company estimates that may change as results are finalised.

46 days

How long M&S stopped taking online clothing and home orders in 2025.[2]

£206m

Sales the Co-op estimates it lost to its 2025 cyber attack in the first half alone.[4]

€250m

Upper end of Ahold Delhaize's expected fourth-quarter 2026 sales hit, estimated at €200m to €250m.[6]

About 700

French supermarkets affected by the October 2026 refrigeration attacks, according to the French finance minister.[8]

1,617

Incidents of violence and abuse against UK retail staff a day, September 2024 to August 2025.[11]

£18m or 5%

Maximum UK Martyn's Law penalty for enhanced duty premises: £18m or 5% of worldwide revenue.[13]

TIMELINE

From one Easter weekend to November 2026

Key dates. Company dates are as disclosed; incident dates as reported.

25 April 2025 — **M&S pauses online orders**
After contactless and click and collect problems over Easter. The pause lasts 46 days.[2]

1 May 2025 — **UK NCSC steps in**
The UK's NCSC confirms it is working with UK retailers affected by cyber incidents.[17]

16 July 2025 — **Co-op data confirmed**
The Co-op says data on all 6.5 million members was taken.[5]

24 February 2026 — **UK BRC Crime Report**
Violence and abuse against UK retail staff falls to 1,617 incidents a day.[11]

29 April 2026 — **UK Crime and Policing Act**
Royal Assent for the UK Act containing a new retail worker assault offence.[18]

6 October 2026 — **ASOS app alert**
App users receive an unauthorised push notification claiming a hack.[7,19]

11 to 12 October — **Two retail shocks**
Ahold Delhaize takes systems offline; CERT-FR warns of compromised fridge controllers.[16,20]

2 November 2026 — **Second fridge wave**
Stores in Ireland, Belgium and Sweden, and UK food suppliers, are hit.[9,10,21]

4 to 5 November — **Costs and warnings**
Ahold Delhaize cuts guidance; US agencies warn about refrigeration controllers.[6,22]

PART 01

The outage.

Four incidents, four ways a retailer's systems can stop it trading normally.

01 2025: the spring that emptied shelves

02 2026: the back office and the app

03 Four incidents compared

04 Breach notification by region

THE OUTAGE

2025: the spring that emptied the shelves

> **Every shutdown decision has a store and supply chain consequence that must be planned for in advance.**

M&S first disclosed a cyber incident on 22 April 2025, after problems with contactless payments and click and collect over the Easter weekend. On 25 April it stopped taking online orders for clothing and home, and did not restart them for 46 days. It said attackers had got in by tricking staff at a third-party contractor.[2]

The company's own account shows how a cyber response becomes an operational one. Containing the attack meant disconnecting warehouse management systems, which paused online orders, click and collect and in-store ordering. Manual processes were introduced to keep forecasting, ordering and replenishment going, and customers could shop in stores throughout.[14]

The cost was large but smaller than first feared. In May 2025 M&S estimated a hit to operating profit of around £300m before mitigation.[1] A year later it reported £131.3m of incident costs within adjusting items and £100m of insurance proceeds, describing 2025/26 as a year of two halves.[3] Its online offer was restored in August 2025.[14]

The Co-op took a different path to the same place. It shut down systems to contain its attack and kept stores trading, but faced payment problems and stock shortages.[4] It estimated lost sales of at least £206m and an £80m profit hit in the six months to 5 July 2025, with around £120m expected for the full year.[4] It later confirmed that names, addresses and contact details of all 6.5 million members had been taken, with no financial data involved.[5]

In July 2025 the National Crime Agency arrested four people in connection with attacks on M&S, the Co-op and Harrods.[5] The NCSC called the incidents a wake-up call for all organisations.[17]

The lesson for retailers is not that systems should never be switched off. It is that every shutdown decision has a store and supply chain consequence that must be planned for in advance.

THE OUTAGE

2026: the back office and the customer's phone

> **The first public sign of an attack may be a message your customers see before your own teams do.**

On 11 October 2026 Ahold Delhaize took some systems offline after identifying a security issue in its network. It said stores remained open and that it had no evidence that customer or associate data had been stolen.[15,20]

The effects were felt most online and in logistics. Albert Heijn's online ordering reopened on 23 October, with delivery fleets initially running at about a third of normal capacity. In stores, some electronic shelf labels showed outdated promotional prices and digital loyalty card scanners temporarily failed.[15]

On 4 November the group set out the bill. It expects the incident to cut fourth-quarter net sales by €200m to €250m and operating income by €75m to €100m, mostly through disruption to online capabilities in the Benelux and the US and to Benelux supply chain operations. Its chief executive said most of the disruption was contained within two weeks.[6]

ASOS faced a different kind of incident. On 6 October 2026 app users received a push notification claiming the retailer had been hacked and urging staff to make contact.[7] ASOS said an attacker had obtained an employee's login credentials by impersonating a trusted contact, then used them to access information on certain third-party platforms and send the notification. It said names and contact details may have been accessed, but not payment card details or passwords.[7]

The market reacted before the facts were known: ASOS shares fell as much as 15% in London that day.[19] The attacker's claim of a wider data compromise had not been confirmed when this report was written.

Two lessons stand out. Customer channels such as push notifications are now part of the incident surface. And the first public sign of an attack may be a message your customers see before your own teams do.

FOUR INCIDENTS

What was hit, what kept working, what it cost

Disclosed figures only. Company estimates may be revised.

RETAILER	WHAT WAS HIT	WHAT KEPT WORKING	DISCLOSED IMPACT
M&S, 2025	Online orders paused 46 days; warehouse systems disconnected.[2,14]	Stores traded throughout, with manual processes.[14]	£131.3m incident costs; £100m insurance.[3]
Co-op, 2025	Systems shut down; payment problems and stock shortages.[4]	Stores kept trading.[4]	At least £206m lost sales in H1; 6.5m members' data taken.[4,5]
Ahold Delhaize, 2026	Online in the Benelux and US; Benelux supply chain.[6]	Stores stayed open; online reopened after about two weeks.[15,20]	Q4 sales down €200m to €250m (estimate).[6]
ASOS, 2026	Push notification channel; data on third-party platforms.[7]	Shopping continued; no card data or passwords taken, it says.[7]	Names and contact details may be exposed; shares fell up to 15% on the day.[7,19]

REGIONAL NOTES · BREACH NOTIFICATION

Who a retailer must tell after a breach, and how fast

Two of the four incidents involved customer data. Wherever a retailer trades, deadlines run from awareness, so the moment of awareness must be logged.

REGIONAL NOTE · UNITED KINGDOM

UK GDPR Article 33: notify the regulator without undue delay and, where feasible, within 72 hours of becoming aware of a personal data breach, unless it is unlikely to result in a risk to people. From 30 September 2026 the text names the Information Commission, which took over from the ICO.[23]

IN PRACTICE Record the time of awareness and the risk assessment. A late notice must give reasons.

REGIONAL NOTE · EUROPEAN UNION

GDPR Article 33: notify the competent supervisory authority without undue delay and, where feasible, within 72 hours. Article 34: tell affected people without undue delay where the breach is likely to result in a high risk to them.[26]

IN PRACTICE Groups trading in several member states should know their lead supervisory authority in advance.

REGIONAL NOTE · UNITED STATES

All states, the District of Columbia, Puerto Rico and the Virgin Islands have breach notification laws; triggers and deadlines vary.[24] For card data, PCI DSS Requirement 12.10.1 (an industry standard, applied through acquirers) requires an incident response plan covering notification of payment brands and acquirers.[25]

IN PRACTICE Map customers by state, and keep acquirer and payment brand contacts in the plan, wherever you trade.

REGIONAL NOTE · MIDDLE EAST

UAE: Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021 requires controllers to report breaches to the UAE Data Office; timing is left to Executive Regulations, which legal summaries report as not yet published. DIFC and ADGM have their own laws.[27] **Saudi Arabia:** the PDPL is fully enforceable from 14 September 2024; notify SDAIA within 72 hours where a breach is likely to cause harm. A draft amendment would drop that harm test (proposed).[28]

IN PRACTICE Check which law applies to each store, including free zone sites.

A summary for orientation, not legal advice. Requirements depend on sector, size, licence and jurisdiction, and change over time. Confirm the current text with your legal and compliance teams.

PART 02

The store itself.

When the threat is a warm freezer or an aggressive customer, the incident starts and ends with the people on shift.

01 The fridge attacks

02 How a controller becomes a weapon

03 Cold-chain rules by region

04 Violence, abuse and the UK law

THE FRIDGE ATTACKS

When the freezer is switched off from the internet

> **A store that cannot prove its cold chain held has to assume it did not.**

On 12 October 2026 France's CERT-FR warned that it knew of numerous compromises of remote controllers for refrigeration installations: Danfoss AK-SC and AK-SM series and Copeland and Dixell XWEB systems. It said exposing a management interface on the internet runs against good practice, and that attack campaigns were probably still under way.[16]

The French finance minister told lawmakers that about 700 supermarkets were affected. Retailers including Carrefour, Coopérative U, E.Leclerc, Intermarché and Monoprix confirmed impact, and two supermarkets in Alsace reported combined losses of €270,000. Danfoss said most affected units were end-of-life models no longer receiving patches.[8]

A second wave on 2 November reached other countries. Le Monde Informatique reported around 40 Delhaize stores in Belgium, ICA stores in Sweden and at least 13 SuperValu stores in Ireland, with attackers again triggering defrost cycles.[9] SuperValu's owner took chilled and frozen products off sale as a precaution and said all stores were trading normally by that evening.[21]

The UK was not untouched. Members of the Association of Independent Meat Suppliers and a London fruit and vegetable wholesaler had equipment switched to defrost, but no stock was lost.[10,29] The UK's NCSC said it was working with affected organisations and that the impact so far was minimal; no UK supermarket chain had been confirmed as directly affected.[10,29]

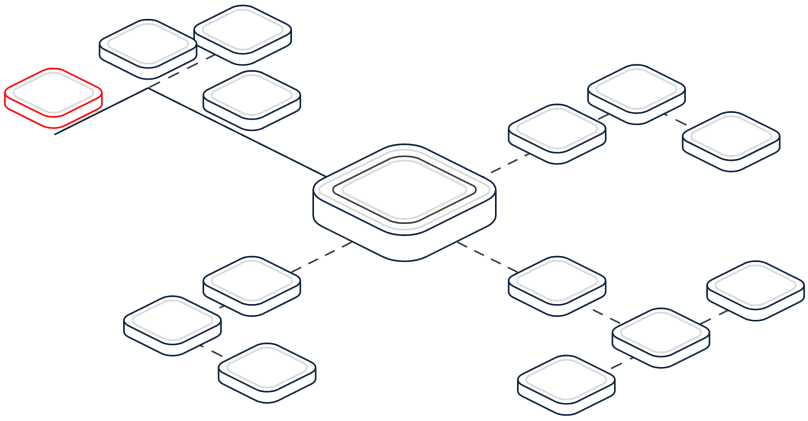
On 5 November US agencies including CISA and the FBI warned of ongoing attacks on refrigeration and cold chain monitoring systems, citing inventory loss, fire hazards and unsafe storage conditions.[22]

For food retailers this is a food safety issue as much as a cyber one. In England, Wales and Northern Ireland chilled food must legally be kept at 8°C or below.[30] A store that cannot prove its cold chain held has to assume it did not.

HOW IT WORKS

Four steps from exposed panel to empty shelf

As described by CERT-FR, vendors and US agencies.



01 **Find the panel**

Controller web interfaces reachable from the internet, often on end-of-life kit.[8,16]

02 **Get in**

Authentication flaws and weak or default passwords, some long since patched.[8,10,22]

03 **Change the settings**

Defrost triggered or stretched, or units pushed into heating.[9,22]

04 **Leave the store to cope**

Stock is discarded and staff must check, quarantine and restock.[8,21]

REGIONAL NOTES · COLD CHAIN

The temperature rules a tampered fridge can break

After a remote defrost, a store has to show the food stayed within the limit that applies where it trades. These are the reference points in four regions.

REGIONAL NOTE · UNITED KINGDOM

Chilled food must legally be kept at 8°C or below in England, Wales and Northern Ireland, according to the Food Standards Agency.[30]

IN PRACTICE Probe the food, not the controller display, and keep the readings. Stores in Scotland should check Food Standards Scotland guidance.

REGIONAL NOTE · EUROPEAN UNION

Regulation (EC) No 852/2004, Annex II, Chapter IX: foods that can support pathogens must not be kept at temperatures that risk health, and the cold chain is not to be interrupted, with limited periods allowed for handling.[32]

IN PRACTICE National rules and each business's own food safety procedures set the working limits.

REGIONAL NOTE · UNITED STATES

The FDA Food Code is a model code adopted by state and local jurisdictions. The 2022 edition requires time/temperature control for safety food to be cold-held at 5°C (41°F) or less.[31]

IN PRACTICE Check the edition your state or county has adopted; local amendments differ.

REGIONAL NOTE · MIDDLE EAST (UAE)

The Dubai Municipality Food Code says high-risk food should be kept at or below 5°C, or at or above 60°C, and calls 5°C to 60°C the temperature danger zone.[33] Other emirates and GCC states set their own rules.

IN PRACTICE Confirm the authority and limits for each emirate or country.

A summary for orientation, not legal advice. Requirements depend on sector, size, licence and jurisdiction, and change over time. Confirm the current text with your legal and compliance teams.

VIOLENCE AND THE LAW

Violence, abuse and the UK laws catching up

> **A specific offence of assaulting a retail worker is now law, but is not yet in force.**

In the UK, the BRC Crime Report 2026 estimates more than 1,600 incidents of violence and abuse against retail staff a day, about 590,000 in the year to August 2025. That is down from over 2,000 a day the year before, but far above the 455 a day recorded in 2019 to 2020.[11] Around 118 incidents a day involved physical violence, and incidents involving a weapon fell from 68 to 36 a day.[11]

Reporting remains patchy. Only 15% of all incidents of abuse, threats and violence were reported to the police, although retailers reported 55% of physically violent incidents.[11] Usdaw's own survey of 9,481 retail staff found 77% had been verbally abused in the previous year, 53% threatened and 10% assaulted.[34]

UK law is changing. The Crime and Policing Act 2026 received Royal Assent on 29 April 2026.[18]

Section 45 makes it an offence to assault a retail worker at work, covering anyone working on or about retail premises for the owner or occupier, including unpaid work, and is triable summarily with up to six months in prison, a fine or both.[12] The legislation.gov.uk text still marks the section as prospective: it is not yet in force, and no commencement date has been published.[12,18]

Section 46 adds a duty on courts to make a criminal behaviour order for the offence, subject to conditions in the Act, and section 47 makes theft from a shop triable either way whatever the value of the goods, ending the £200 threshold.[11,35]

In the UK, Martyn's Law adds a different duty. The Terrorism (Protection of Premises) Act 2025 applies to premises wholly or mainly used for listed purposes, including shops, where 200 or more people can reasonably be expected at the same time.[13] Standard tier premises will need evacuation, invacuation, lockdown and communication procedures, so far as is reasonably practicable, and must notify the SIA.[13] The implementation period is at least 24 months from Royal Assent on 3 April 2025.[13]

THE LAW (UK)

UK: what the new rules say, and when they bite

Status as at 9 November 2026. Check legislation.gov.uk and GOV.UK for commencement.

MEASURE	WHAT IT DOES	STATUS
Crime and Policing Act 2026, s.45	Offence of assaulting a retail worker at work; up to six months, a fine or both.[12]	Enacted 29 April 2026; not yet in force.[12,18]
Crime and Policing Act 2026, s.46 and s.47	Duty on courts to make a criminal behaviour order, subject to conditions; shop theft triable either way whatever the value.[35]	Enacted; check commencement before relying on them.
Martyn's Law, standard tier	200 to 799 people: notify the SIA; evacuation, invacuation, lockdown and communication procedures.[13]	Not yet in force; at least 24 months from 3 April 2025.[13]
Martyn's Law, enhanced tier	800 or more people: public protection measures and wider duties; penalties up to £18m or 5% of worldwide revenue.[13]	Not yet in force; standard tier penalties up to £10,000.[13]
UK food hygiene law	Chilled food kept at 8°C or below in England, Wales and Northern Ireland.[30]	In force now.

PART 03

What to do now.

What the evidence means for retailers wherever they trade, and the steps that close the gap before and during peak.

01 What it means for retail

02 Where retailers get it wrong

03 Recommendations and board questions

WHAT IT MEANS

What it means for organisations in Retail

> **A cyber incident in retail becomes a store, supplier, customer and food safety event within hours.**

Retail disruption does not respect borders. The incidents in this report hit retailers and suppliers in the UK, the Netherlands, Belgium, France, Sweden, Ireland and the US, and the refrigeration attacks show the threat now reaches equipment most IT teams have never inventoried.[6,8,9,10,22] In the UK alone, the NCSC's Annual Review records 80 nationally significant incidents in the year to August 2026, out of 337 that needed its support.[36]

A cyber incident in retail is rarely just an IT event: it becomes a store event, a supplier event, a customer event and often a food safety event within hours. It can quickly become a legal one too. Personal data breach notification deadlines of 72 hours apply under UK and EU GDPR and, where harm is likely, under Saudi Arabia's PDPL, and every US state has its own notification law.[23,24,26,28] UK retailers in the BRC survey ranked cyber crime as their second biggest crime-related financial concern, after customer theft.[11]

The common thread is coordination. In each case, the hardest work was keeping stores trading safely while head office contained the problem: telling managers what to do, telling customers what still worked and making sure nobody was left guessing. That work depends on fast, two-way communication with every store and a clear record of who has been told what, and when.

Colleague safety sits alongside this. Violence and abuse are a daily reality in stores, and peak trading raises the pressure. In the UK, two new legal frameworks are on the way: retailers that improve reporting now will be ready to use the new offence when it commences, and those that write and rehearse their four Martyn's Law procedures will not be scrambling when the duties begin.

Peaks differ by market: Black Friday, called White Friday in parts of the Gulf, Christmas, and Ramadan and Eid, when Visa found late-night transactions doubled their share in Saudi Arabia.[37,38] The test before each one is practical. Could every store acknowledge one clear instruction within ten minutes? Could you list every internet-facing fridge controller? Would you know who to notify, and by when, in each country you trade in?

COMMON GAPS

Where retailers get it wrong

The gap is rarely technology. It is ownership, communication and rehearsal.

AREA	WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Store communication	Head office decides; stores hear about it from customers or social media.	Every decision has a store message, sent at once and acknowledged by every manager.
Shutdown decisions	Systems are switched off with no view of what stores lose.	A pre-agreed map of each system's store and supply chain dependencies.
Operational technology	Fridge and building controllers left on the internet, run by contractors.	Controllers inventoried, off the internet and reached only through secure access.
Third parties	Contractor and help desk access assumed to be safe.	Supplier access reviewed, limited and verified, with tested reset procedures.
Colleague safety	Abuse treated as part of the job and rarely reported.	Every incident logged and reported, with aftercare and store risk reviews.
Peak readiness	Plans written for a quiet Tuesday.	Rehearsed for the busiest hour of each peak, with peak on-call rotas.
Notification duties	Deadlines discovered during the incident.	A notification map per country: regulator, deadline, acquirer, food authority.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Seven steps before peak

In priority order.

01 Give stores and head office one severity scale

Shared triggers, owners and update rhythm for stores and the crisis team.

02 Make every shutdown decision store-aware

Map what stores, online and supply chain lose with each system, and pre-write the store instruction.[14,15]

03 Get operational technology off the internet

Inventory fridge controllers and building systems, remove internet exposure and replace end-of-life kit.[16,22]

04 Harden people-based access

Train help desks and staff against impersonation and tighten contractor access.[2,7]

05 Pre-approve messages for every audience

Stores, colleagues, customers, regulators, suppliers and media, each with the next update time.

06 Report and support every assault

Make reporting easy, follow up every incident, prepare for the new offence.[11,12]

07 Rehearse before every peak

Exercise a payment outage, a cold-chain incident and a lockdown; in the UK, draft Martyn's Law procedures.[13]

FOR THE BOARD

Questions boards should ask

Answers should be specific, dated and owned.

TRADING

- ? If we had to take core systems offline tomorrow, which stores, channels and suppliers would stop, and how would we tell them?
- ? How many of our refrigeration controllers and building systems are reachable from the internet?
- ? How quickly can every store acknowledge a single instruction?

PEOPLE AND LAW

- ? How many assaults on colleagues were reported last quarter, and what support followed?
- ? Do we know who we must notify after a data breach in each country we trade in, and how fast?
- ? When did we last rehearse an incident with store and head office together?

GLOSSARY

Terms used in this report

Push notification
A message sent by an app straight to a customer's phone screen.

Social engineering
Tricking a person into giving access, for example by impersonating a colleague or supplier.

Refrigeration controller
A device that runs fridges and freezers, often reachable remotely by engineers.

Defrost cycle
A scheduled warm-up that clears ice. Stretched or repeated, it spoils stock.

End of life
When a manufacturer stops issuing security fixes for a product.

Operational technology
Systems that control physical equipment, such as refrigeration, lighting or access.

Adjusting items
Costs a company reports separately from underlying profit, such as one-off incident costs.

Prospective
A provision that is law but has not yet been brought into force.

Invacuation
Moving people to a safer place inside a building, away from danger outside.

SIA
The UK Security Industry Authority, which will regulate Martyn's Law.

Standard and enhanced tier
UK Martyn's Law categories for premises expecting 200 to 799 people, and 800 or more.

Cold chain
Keeping chilled and frozen food at safe temperatures from supplier to shelf.

Supervisory authority
The data protection regulator that receives breach notifications.

WHY COORDINATION, NOT JUST NOTIFICATION

Most organisations can send alerts. Few can manage incidents end-to-end.

When card payments fail on the busiest trading day of the year, a message to stores is minute one. Trading through it depends on which stores acknowledged, who switched to the fallback, what customers were told, and an accurate picture for head office.

WHERE INCIDENTS GO WRONG

01	**Fragmented information**	Different teams work from different information.
02	**Delayed decision making**	Leadership lacks visibility, so decisions wait.
03	**Uncoordinated response**	Several teams work independently on the same problem.
04	**Lack of visibility**	Critical actions become difficult to track.
05	**Lack of accountability**	Actions and decisions are poorly documented.

THE WHOLE INCIDENT, IN ONE PLATFORM



Crises Control is an **Operational Incident Coordination Platform**. It helps organisations maintain operational control during incidents by combining alerting, coordination, execution, visibility and accountability in one platform.

WHAT IS STANDARD, WHAT IS CONFIGURED

Clear about what the platform does.

Some capabilities work as standard. Others depend on how your team sets up plans, groups and rules, or on connecting your own systems. Your demonstration and implementation plan confirm what applies to you.

STANDARD	CONFIGURED	INTEGRATIONS
Included in how each module works.	Set up by your team to match your plans.	Connected to your other systems, where configured.
SOS press-and-hold alert from the mobile app, raising an incident and sharing location where available	Response plans, task lists and message templates per incident type	Directory sync with Microsoft Entra ID, SCIM or scheduled file import
Ping alerts by push, SMS, voice, email and desktop, with one-tap acknowledgement	Groups, sites and audiences to target	Single sign-on with Entra ID, Google Workspace or Okta
Incident Manager workspace, roles and a single communication log	Escalation rules and timings when people do not respond	The Microsoft Teams app, enabled by your administrator
Task Manager tasks with owners and deadlines when a plan is activated	Cascading from one channel to the next	Triggers from monitoring or other systems, set up as an integration project
Control Centre live view of status, acknowledgements, tasks and locations	Response options people can choose when they acknowledge	
Audit & Reporting: timestamped records, exportable as PDF or CSV		
CRAiG (beta): answers questions and summarises your incident data within each user's permissions		

> Crises Control does not detect incidents on its own. Incidents are raised by people, through SOS, the app or the web, or by connected systems where an integration has been configured. From that point the platform coordinates the response.

USE CASES

How organisations use Crises Control in retail

From the first alert to the final record: the incidents this platform is used for, and how the modules work together in each.

Store emergencies and evacuations

ILLUSTRATIVE

TRIGGER Fire, security threat, violence, severe weather or another store emergency

Alert store employees and managers, provide instructions, track acknowledgements and coordinate response and reopening tasks.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Control Centre | SOS | Audit & Reporting

Cold-chain and refrigeration failures

ILLUSTRATIVE

TRIGGER Refrigeration or temperature monitoring indicates stock may be outside safe limits

Notify store and facilities teams, assign checks and corrective actions, escalate unresolved issues and record actions taken.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Control Centre | Audit & Reporting

Multi-store incident coordination

ILLUSTRATIVE

TRIGGER A disruption affects multiple stores or regions

Notify affected stores and regional managers, share consistent instructions, coordinate local actions and give head office visibility of progress.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Control Centre | Audit & Reporting

Business continuity and store reopening

ILLUSTRATIVE

TRIGGER A store must close, operate differently or reopen after an incident

Distribute store-specific continuity instructions, assign recovery and safety checks, confirm completion and communicate reopening decisions.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Control Centre

Payment, IT and cybersecurity disruption

ILLUSTRATIVE

TRIGGER Payment terminals, point-of-sale systems, networks or applications become unavailable

Alert affected stores and support teams, communicate workarounds and updates, assign technical and operational actions, and monitor recovery.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Control Centre | Audit & Reporting

Customer examples are based on how customers use Crises Control today; customer names have been removed. Customer requirements describe needs raised by customers or in evaluations. Intended, suggested and illustrative use cases show how the platform can be applied and are not presented as existing customer deployments. Capabilities marked 'where configured' or 'where supported' depend on each organisation's set-up.

READINESS ASSESSMENT

How ready is your response?

Score each area from 0 (not in place) to 3 (fully in place) for your retail organisation, then add up the total.

AREA	THE QUESTION	SCORE 0 TO 3
01 · ACTIVATION **Alert**	Can you reach the right people on more than one channel within minutes, day or night? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Every store manager and on-call colleague reached in minutes, on more than one channel.	0 1 2 3
02 · ACTIVATION **Acknowledge**	Do you know who has seen the alert, and does silence trigger escalation by rule? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Store-by-store acknowledgement, with escalation when a store stays silent.	0 1 2 3
03 · COORDINATION **Escalate**	Are escalation paths set by role and time, not by whoever remembers who to call? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Escalation from store to region to head office runs by rule.	0 1 2 3
04 · COORDINATION **Coordinate**	Is there one shared workspace and log for the incident, not scattered calls, chats and inboxes? GOOD LOOKS LIKE One incident log shared by IT, store operations, loss prevention and communications.	0 1 2 3
05 · EXECUTION **Execute**	Are your procedures turned into owned tasks with deadlines that someone can track? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Fallback, lockdown and cold-chain procedures run as owned tasks in every store.	0 1 2 3
06 · EXECUTION **See**	Can leaders see tasks, people, locations and blockers live, without having to ask? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Head office sees which stores are trading, closed or at risk, live.	0 1 2 3
07 · ASSURANCE **Prove**	Could you produce a timestamped timeline for a regulator, insurer or inquiry within a day? GOOD LOOKS LIKE A timeline for insurers, data protection regulators or a post-incident review, ready the next day.	0 1 2 3
08 · ASSURANCE **Rehearse**	Do you exercise the whole response, not just the call tree, at least once a year? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Peak-trading scenarios rehearsed with stores, not only at head office.	0 1 2 3

0 to 8
Alerting only
You can send messages. The response still depends on people and luck.

9 to 16
Coordinating in parts
Some steps work. Gaps appear at night, at scale or when systems fail.

17 to 24
Coordinated and provable
You can run the response and show exactly what happened.

BUYER'S GUIDE

Eight questions to ask any incident platform supplier

Many tools can send an alert. These questions separate a notification tool from a platform that coordinates the whole response.

01 **Does it stop at the message?**
Ask what the platform does after the alert is sent: tasks, log, escalation, recovery.

02 **Can it prove who acknowledged?**
Delivery is not acknowledgement. Ask how silence is spotted and escalated, and what you must configure.

03 **Does it run your procedures?**
Ask whether your plans become owned tasks with deadlines, or stay as documents.

04 **Is there one shared picture?**
Ask what leaders see live, and whether it needs someone to update a spreadsheet.

05 **Does it work when your systems do not?**
Ask how teams coordinate if email, chat or your network is down.

06 **Can frontline staff raise the alarm?**
Ask how a colleague on site escalates, with their location where available, in one action.

07 **What evidence does it leave behind?**
Ask for a sample timeline of the kind a regulator, insurer or inquiry would want.

08 **Can you rehearse in it?**
Ask whether you can run exercises on the same platform you would use for real.

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Watch a multi-store outage run end to end.

Most organisations can send alerts. Few can manage incidents end-to-end. In a live, 30-minute demonstration built around a retail incident, you will see how our incident management software, an Operational Incident Coordination Platform, takes one incident from first alert to final report. Bring your own scenario.

WHAT YOU WILL SEE

01	SOS	A store manager reports tills down, with location where available.
02	PING	Store managers and regional managers are alerted; each store acknowledges.
03	INCIDENT MANAGER	Head office activates the incident and assigns store, regional and head office roles.
04	TASK MANAGER	Fallback, customer messaging and cash procedures become tasks in every store.
05	CONTROL CENTRE	Head office sees which stores are trading, closed or at risk.
06	AUDIT & REPORTING	The incident timeline is produced for insurers and the review.
07	CRAIG	CRAiG helps head office find information in the platform and summarise the incident so far.

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SCAN TO BOOK

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